

academic institutions to establish Centres of Excellence,” says Kathir Thandavarayan, partner, Deloitte India. He recommends strong industry-academia partnerships, including in-plant training programmes at global semiconductor manufacturing sites, hosting of workshops by experienced industry professionals, and integrating real-time industrial projects into academic curricula.

CG Semi is already working on these lines. Renesas, its partner, provides training and technical know-how to local talent onboarded by CG Semi. CG Semi has recruited professionals with OSAT experience to mentor Indian engineers via classroom sessions and hands-on training. “India has so much talent. If we don’t absorb it by developing technology here, we will be doing a disservice to the country,” says Subbiah of CG Power.

India’s ambition, however, is weighed down by past policy reversals, litigation risks, and bureaucratic delays. Large-scale fabs demand long-term certainty, stable tariffs, incentives, and intellectual property protection. Prime Minister Narendra Modi used the first Semicon India conference in April 2022 to signal a clean break with the past. “While the industry works hard, the government must work even harder,” he said. He reiterated his government’s commitment at the fourth edition of the conference earlier this month. “The shorter the time from file to factory, and the lesser the paperwork, the sooner wafer work can begin.” He said “the national single window system has been implemented, enabling all approvals from both Centre and states to be accessed on a single platform. As a result, investors have been freed from extensive paperwork. Semiconductor parks are being developed under a plug-and-play model, which offer facilities



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Chairman, CG Power

gs: A Timeline

2022

- ▶ ISMC (Next Orbit + Tower Semiconductor) proposes a fab in Karnataka, but the deal is stalled after Intel announces plans to acquire Tower
- ▶ IGSS Ventures (Singapore-based) proposes a fab in Tamil Nadu but later withdraws

- ▶ Vedanta-Foxconn JV announces a \$20 billion fab and display project in Gujarat. Foxconn exits in 2023 citing delays and viability issues
- ▶ Semicon 1.0 revised in September: 50% incentive to all semiconductor fabs and testing and packing plants

2024

- ▶ **February:** MoU between India and Taiwan on facilitation of employment of Indian workers in Taiwan’s semiconductor hub
- ▶ **February:** Three proposals approved
 - Tata Electronics fab in Dholera, Gujarat
 - CG Power testing and packing plant in Sanand, Gujarat
 - Tata Electronics testing and packing plant in Assam
- ▶ **September:** Cabinet approves Kaynes Semicon packing project

2023

- ▶ **In January,** India and the US launch the Initiative on Critical and Emerging Technologies, putting semiconductors at the centre of bilateral cooperation for supply chain resilience, R&D, and talent development.
- ▶ **June:** Micron ATMP project in Gujarat approved
- ▶ **July:** India and Japan sign an deal to build a resilient semiconductor supply chain and leverage complementary strengths
- ▶ **November:** EU-India MoU focusing on working arrangements related to semiconductor ecosystem, supply chain and innovation signed

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